OPPORTUNITY BRIEF · SALES AND PRESALES

Implement zero trust for machine identities in federal agencies

Public / Government sector × Identity and access management × Zero trust architecture · OS102 v1 · refreshed 2026-08-18

ATTRACTIVENESS	RIGHT TO WIN	COMPETITION	SERVICEABLE MARKET	HORIZON	PORTFOLIO
68 is the world moving	**76** can we play, can we win	**MEDIUM** 3 named in the evidence	**€220m** observed evidence · per year	**NEXT** pilots published no volume pr...	**L0** 13 signals

Attractiveness and right to win are scored and displayed separately and are never combined (SC-12). Competition is a fourth quantity, not a discount on either.

The opportunity

Federal agencies are moving from identity-centric zero trust to machine identity management, a critical gap in their zero trust architectures. This opportunity is for public sector CISOs and identity teams who must secure nonhuman entities like APIs, bots, and certificates as they adopt AI and cloud services. The urgency comes from published pilots and guidance, but volume procurement has not yet begun, making this a strategic early-mover moment.

Market opportunity

Method	Total (TAM)	Serviceable (SAM)	Obtainable (SOM)	Confidence
Observed: tendered contract value, annualised	**€220m** €220m – €482m	**€220m** €220m – €482m	**€13.2m** €13.2m – €28.9m	observed

All figures are annual, in EUR. Ranges compound the uncertainty of each factor below; the base case is the middle column of each.

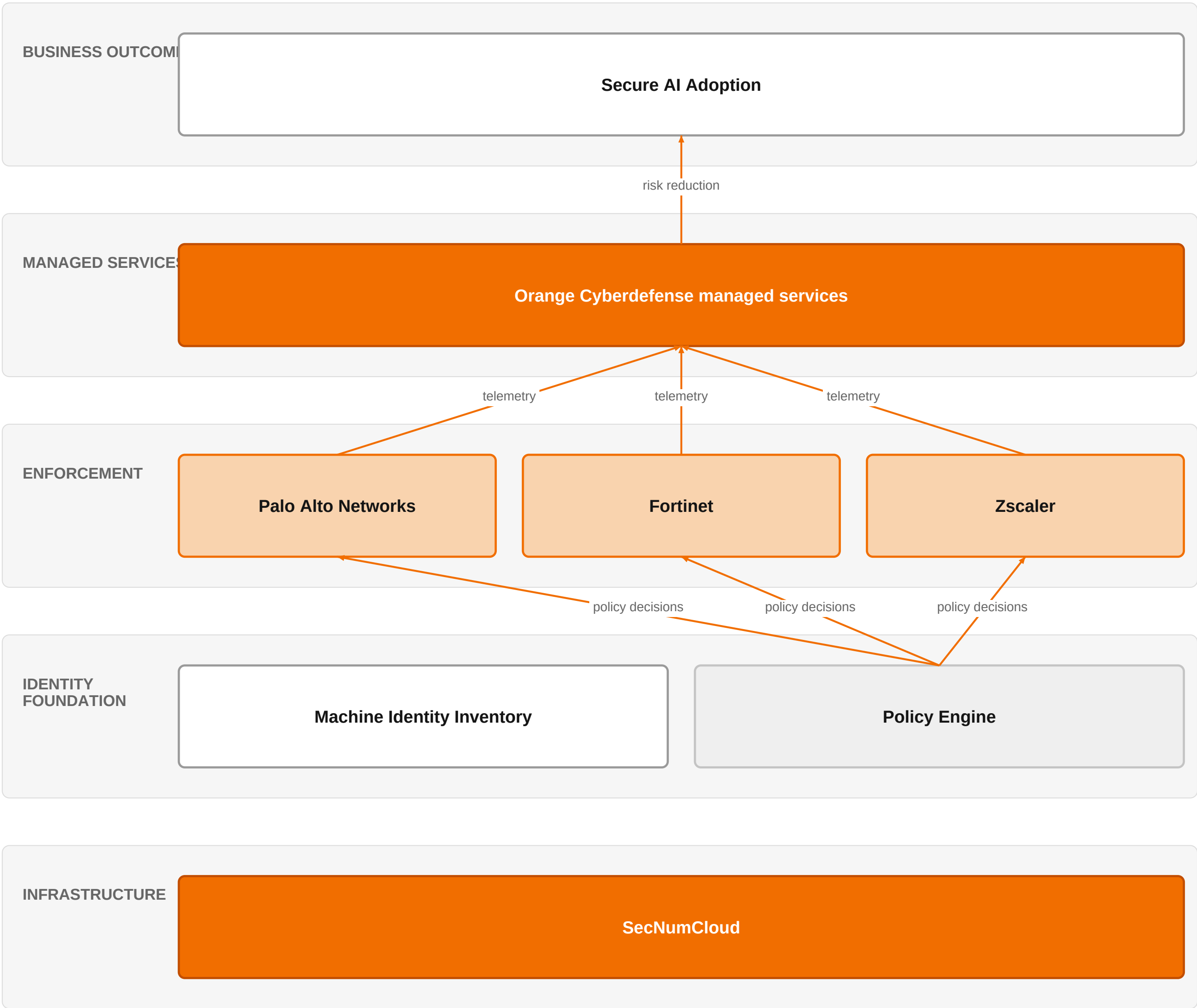
Observed: tendered contract value, annualised

Factor	Value	Basis	Source	As of
Tendered contract value in matching CPV categories	€220m per year	observed	TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) · ted	2026-05-19..2026-08-05
Assumed obtainable share of the serviceable market	6.0 % of SAM	assumption	config/sizing.yaml · obtainable_share	size-2026-08-a

Read this before quoting the number. Observed over 85 days of TED coverage and scaled to a year (x4.3); a short collection window makes that scaling rough. 34 matching notices, matched on vertical via the CPV crosswalk — §4.5.2's warning applies: a crosswalk error lands directly in this number. Public procurement only. Private-sector demand for the same capability is not visible here at all, so this is a floor rather than a market size. 1 of 1 declared geographies are outside the European reference data (US); the estimate covers the European footprint only.

The solution, in one picture

Machine Identity Zero Trust for Federal Agencies



■ Orange asset ■ Partner ■ Customer-owned ■ Third party / to be sourced

Orange orchestrates a sovereign, managed zero trust for machine identities, integrating partner enforcement points to secure AI adoption.

Boxes marked as Orange assets are validated against the linked business graph; a box the model claimed for Orange without a matching asset is shown as third party.

What has changed

Zero trust has evolved from a network-centric model to one where identity is the foundation, especially for secure AI adoption in government (SIG-ED4013FC65F2). Machine identities—nonhuman entities like APIs and certificates—are now recognized as a critical, often overlooked component of federal zero trust (SIG-5A3260810D62). As agencies scale AI, they must apply zero trust to machine identities to avoid implicit trust (SIG-333EF44491DD). The market is seeing a proliferation of zero trust solution types, but most organizations are implementing them incorrectly, focusing on tools rather than intent (SIG-B40F6F6137FE, SIG-E94A28E305BA).

`Sources: SIG-ED4013FC65F2 Federal News Network 2026-06-18; SIG-5A3260810D62 FedTech Magazine 2026-06-08; SIG-333EF44491DD Microsoft 2026-04-29; SIG-B40F6F6137FE BOSS Publishing 2026-06-11; SIG-E94A28E305BA Network World 2026-05-27`

Who buys, and why now

The buyer is the federal agency CISO or deputy CISO, with the identity and access management (IAM) team feeling the pain daily. The trigger is an audit finding, a mandate deadline, or a security incident involving a compromised machine credential. Operationally, they struggle with an explosion of nonhuman identities—service accounts, API keys, certificates—that lack visibility and lifecycle management, creating blind spots that attackers exploit. They need to demonstrate compliance and reduce risk without slowing down mission-critical operations.

Sources: SIG-5A3260810D62 FedTech Magazine 2026-06-08

Why it is hot now — every claim bound to a dated source

- Machine identity management is critical for federal zero trust. [SIG-5A3260810D62]

What Orange would deliver, and why it can win

What Orange would deliver

Orange would assemble a managed service engagement leveraging Orange Cyberdefense managed services, backed by our Cybersecurity experts and Defense and security experts. The engagement would start with an assessment of the agency's current machine identity posture, using our ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certified processes to ensure sovereignty. We would then deploy a zero trust architecture for machine identities, integrating with partner technologies from Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, and Zscaler for network and endpoint enforcement. Finally, we would provide ongoing managed detection and response, with Orange Group researchers feeding threat intelligence into the service.

Why Orange can win

Orange can win because we combine sovereign, certified infrastructure (SecNumCloud, CISPE) with deep cybersecurity expertise and managed services. Our Defense and security experts understand federal requirements, and our partnership with Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, and Zscaler allows us to integrate best-of-breed technology without vendor lock-in. Unlike pure security vendors, we bring a full-service, managed approach that addresses the operational burden on agency staff. However, our machine identity-specific intellectual property is not yet proven, so we must lean on our partners and our ability to orchestrate.

Named assets behind this — each individually inspectable (LK-08)

Asset	Type	Link	Why it is linked	Curator
Orange Cyberdefense managed services	offer	L0	offer addresses the use case AND provides the technology	unconfirmed
Palo Alto Networks	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
Fortinet	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
Zscaler	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
ISO 27001	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
SecNumCloud	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
CISPE	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
Cybersecurity experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Defense and security experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Orange Group researchers	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Grand Paris Sud	reference	SUP	published reference in this vertical, different use case	unconfirmed

Competitive landscape

MEDIUM competitive intensity (score 7.0; 3 of 8 listed players appear in this topic's own evidence)

A real field, including at least one player the customer will already know. Expect to be compared.

Palo Alto Networks, a security specialist and our partner, sells zero trust architecture and is strong in network security (SIG-10E1BC61FB2F). IBM, a global systems integrator, is active in the public sector and strong in enterprise IT services (SIG-686BD5025342). Microsoft, a hyperscaler and our partner, is strong in identity and cloud platforms (SIG-333EF44491DD). CrowdStrike, Fortinet, Zscaler, Cisco, and Bechtle also sell zero trust architecture, each with strengths in endpoint, network, or integration. The customer will compare us against these specialists, so we must differentiate on sovereign managed services and cross-vendor integration.

Sources: SIG-10E1BC61FB2F Palo Alto Networks 2026-05-12; SIG-686BD5025342 IBM 2026-05-28; SIG-333EF44491DD Microsoft 2026-04-29

Competitor	Category	Position here	Basis	Evidence

Palo Alto Networks	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	evidenced	SIG-10E1BC61FB2F
IBM	Global systems integrator	active in Public / Government sector; competes in Cybersecurity	evidenced	SIG-686BD5025342
Microsoft	Hyperscaler	named in this topic's evidence — also an Orange partner	evidenced	SIG-333EF44491DD
CrowdStrike	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity	structural	—
Fortinet	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Zscaler	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Cisco	Network equipment vendor	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Bechtle	Regional integrator or reseller	sells Zero trust architecture	structural	—

evidenced means this topic's own sources name the competitor — the signal ids are in the last column and are dated and clickable in the radar. **structural** means the curated register says they sell this technology into this vertical, which is true but is not proof they are in this deal. Register version competitors-2026-08-a.

Qualifying questions for the first meeting

1. How many machine identities (service accounts, API keys, certificates) do you currently track, and what percentage are unmanaged?
2. Have you experienced an incident or audit finding related to a compromised machine credential in the past 12 months?
3. What is your current zero trust maturity level, and does your roadmap explicitly address machine identities?
4. Are you required to use sovereign or certified cloud services (e.g., SecNumCloud) for your identity infrastructure?
5. Which vendors are you already using for identity and network security, and are you open to a managed service that orchestrates them?

Objections you will meet

They will say	You can answer
We already have a zero trust program with a security vendor; why do we need Orange?	That's fair—many agencies have started. But most implementations focus on user identities and network segmentation, leaving machine identities a gap. We complement your existing tools with a managed service that specifically addresses nonhuman entities, and we can integrate with your current vendors rather than replacing them.
We are concerned about sovereignty and data residency for our identity data.	Understood. Orange offers SecNumCloud and CISPE certified services, which are designed for European sovereignty requirements. We can host your machine identity management in a sovereign cloud, and our ISO 27001 processes ensure compliance.
This seems like a niche problem; we have bigger priorities.	It is niche, but it's a growing attack surface. As you scale AI and cloud services, machine identities multiply, and attackers are targeting them. A small investment now can prevent a major incident later. We can start with a focused assessment to quantify your exposure.

Risks and unknowns

The main risk is that this topic is fading—pilots are published but volume procurement has not started, so the market may not materialize quickly. There is also a risk that agencies will prefer to buy point solutions from security specialists rather than a managed service from an integrator. What is genuinely unknown is the specific regulatory requirements for machine identity management in federal zero trust, and whether Orange's managed service can achieve the necessary certifications for this niche. We also lack a reference in the federal space for this exact use case.

Next action, by role (FR-17)

Role	Do this next
Presales / Proposal	Prepare a bid brief for a federal agency's zero-trust initiative, leveraging Orange Cyberdefense managed services, ISO 27001, SecNumCloud, and CISPE certifications, and reference the Grand Paris Sud deployment as proof of our approach, while outlining how we'd integrate with Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, or Zscaler for machine identity protection.

Sales	In a conversation with a federal agency's CISO, say: 'We see machine identities as a critical gap in your zero-trust journey. Orange Cyberdefense managed services, combined with our partners like Zscaler, can help you close that gap—can we schedule a technical deep-dive with our security experts?'
Strategist / Innovator	Deep-dive on the federal zero-trust machine identity market by interviewing Orange Group researchers and Defense and security experts to map the specific procurement triggers and decision-makers, then decide whether to invest in a joint capability with Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, or Zscaler.

Evidence

Every claim in this brief resolves to one of these. Tier 1 is an authoritative primary source; tier 4 is vendor-published material, discounted in scoring (§4.3.7).

Signal	Date	Publisher	T	Title and link
SIG-DECFC4C23DE4	2026-07-31	Veloxx media	2	From Identity to Intent: A Leader’s Journey Through the Evolution of Zero Trust - Veloxx media
SIG-74A5048912D7	2026-07-10	Robotics & Automation News	2	How Zero Trust Network Access Eliminates Implicit Trust at Scale - Robotics & Automation News
SIG-ED4013FC65F2	2026-06-18	Federal News Network	2	Cloud Exchange 2026: Ping Identity’s Kelvin Brewer on identity as foundation of secure AI adopt...
SIG-B40F6F6137FE	2026-06-11	BOSS Publishing	2	5 Types of Zero Trust Solutions to Protect Your Company’s Digital Assets - BOSS Publishing
SIG-5A3260810D62	2026-06-08	FedTech Magazine	2	Machine Identity Management: The Nonhuman Side of Federal Zero Trust - FedTech Magazine
SIG-686BD5025342	2026-05-28	IBM	2	Microsegmentation and zero trust: A natural fit - IBM
SIG-E94A28E305BA	2026-05-27	Network World	2	Zero trust isn’t broken, but most companies are doing it wrong - Network World
SIG-CFBD245A217D	2026-05-24	Industrial Cyber	2	Zero trust in OT moves beyond identity as industrial operators prioritize visibility, segmentat...
SIG-D2DC2DA0537D	2026-05-14	appinventiv.com	2	Zero Trust Architecture Implementation in Australia - appinventiv.com
SIG-10E1BC61FB2F	2026-05-12	Palo Alto Networks	2	Healthfirst Applies an Identity Security-First Approach to Implement Zero Trust - Palo Alto Net...
SIG-08B271ABAD4A	2026-04-30	iTnews	2	State of Security 2026: Zero Trust - iTnews
SIG-2DEFB97AB5D1	2026-04-30	iTnews	2	State of Security 2026: Identity & Access Management - iTnews
SIG-333EF44491DD	2026-04-29	Microsoft	2	Scale AI safely with Zero Trust security - Microsoft

How this brief was made

Computed, not written. Attractiveness, right to win, competitive intensity and every figure in the market-opportunity section are computed from stored inputs and can be re-derived (DR-05, NFR-01). No language model produced a number anywhere in this document (§4.4.4).

Written, then checked. The narrative sections and the solution diagram were generated from this topic's evidence and from the named asset and competitor lists. Factual sections must cite signal ids attached to this topic; sections that failed that check, or that contained a generated quantity or an unsupplied organisation, were removed rather than rewritten.

What	Version	When
Scores — weight set	w-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T19:08:26+00:00
Market sizing — assumptions	size-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:16+00:00
Competitor register	competitors-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:19+00:00
Narrative — prompt / model	describe-v1 / deepseek-chat	2026-08-19T04:57:00+00:00
Pipeline	0.1.0	2026-08-18

Generated 2026-08-19 04:58 UTC. Scores computed under a different weight set are not comparable with these (SC-10), and neither are market sizes computed under a different sizing version.